

Yueh-ya (Sam) Hsu

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Education

PhD Candidate, *Public Policy, Development Economics*, **University of Chicago**, 2024 – present

MPH, *Epidemiology/Biostatistics*, **Washington University in St. Louis**, 2020

BS, *Applied Mathematics*, **University of Colorado Boulder**, *with honors*, 2015

Working Papers

Hsu, Yueh-ya, Reshmaan Hussam, Erin M. Kelley, and Gregory Lane. “Household Preferences for Women’s Employment: A Field Experiment in Bangladesh.” *Submitted*. [\[NBER WP\]](#)

Teaching

Teaching Assistant, **Applied Econometrics II** (PhD) 2026

Teaching Assistant, **Order and Violence** (Master’s) 2025

Teaching Assistant, **Why We Fight** (Undergrad) 2025

Research Experience

PhD Candidate – **University of Chicago**, Chicago, IL *Aug 2024 – present*

- Overseeing research activities for study assessing microfinance for refugees in Kyegegwa, Uganda

Research Professional – **University of Chicago**, Chicago, IL *Aug 2023 – Jul 2024*

- Prepared journal article for study assessing impact of work on psychosocial health in refugee community in Cox’s Bazar, Bangladesh and oversaw policy dissemination with UNHCR, BRAC
- Oversaw research activities for study assessing demand for forecasts and insurance among smallholder farmers in Telangana, India
- Developed partnerships for study assessing microfinance for refugees in Kyegegwa, Uganda

Senior Research Associate – **Harvard Business School**, Cox’s Bazar, Bangladesh *Jun 2022 – Jul 2023*

- Managed research activities for two World Bank projects: (1) evaluation assessing impact of work on psychosocial health and (2) evaluation assessing impact of photography-based intervention intended to develop sense of home for adolescent refugees
- Supervised team of 40+ enumerators, field monitors, and research analysts
- Implemented selection and randomization algorithms; analyzed data in R
- Developed dashboard tools for rapid data monitoring and quality assurance

Consultant – **Refugee Self-Reliance Initiative** *Jan 2022 – Jul 2023*

- Provided technical support to 10+ refugee NGOs to assess self-reliance by curating datasets and creating dashboards; assessed geographic coverage and progress toward self-reliance markers
- Used R (*tidyverse*, *Shiny*) for data cleaning, analysis, and dashboard creation

Research Associate – **Innovations for Poverty Action**, Dhaka, Bangladesh *Nov 2021 – Aug 2022*

- Managed research activities for BRAC's evaluation of Ultra-Poor Graduation program, a multifaceted set of interventions designed to address the complexity of extreme poverty
- Oversaw data quality processes: coding questionnaires in SurveyCTO, developing enumerator training, supervising data backchecks, cleaning, and analysis

Other Experience

<i>Graduate Research Assistant</i> – Social Policy Institute , St. Louis, MO	<i>Oct 2018 – May 2020</i>
<i>Student Researcher</i> – Innovations for Poverty Action , Monrovia, Liberia	<i>Jun 2019 – Mar 2020</i>
<i>Data Specialist</i> – Hannover Re , Denver, CO	<i>Jul 2016 – Jul 2018</i>
<i>Math Fellow</i> – Denver Public Schools , Denver, CO	<i>Nov 2015 – Jun 2016</i>
<i>Research Assistant</i> – University of Colorado Boulder , Boulder, CO	
<i>REACTING Group (Emissions, Air Quality, and Cooking Technologies)</i>	<i>Jun 2014 – Oct 2015</i>
<i>Mathematical Biology Group</i>	<i>May 2012 – Dec 2014</i>

Technical and Language Skills

Relevant Coursework

Math: linear algebra, mathematical statistics, linear models, machine learning, causal inference
 Economics: micro theory (PhD), econometrics (PhD), behavioral economics (PhD)

Programming

Advanced: R, Stata, ODK (SurveyCTO, Kobo, etc.)
Working: L^AT_EX, Python, SQL, PowerShell, GIS
Basic: SAS, MATLAB, SPSS

Languages

Mandarin Chinese (professional working proficiency)
 Bengali (limited working proficiency)

Awards

COMAP International Mathematical Contest in Modeling Apr 2013
Outstanding (top 11 overall of 5,636 teams), *Mathematical Association of America Award*

- Researched water resource crisis in Saudi Arabia and developed water management plan